

CURRICULUM LINKS

There's **so much more** to this fabulous collection of songs than just the music and lyrics. Get the most out of them by exploring some of the ways you can **link their content to wider areas of the curriculum**.

To help you **unpack their potential** in this way, we've given you a head start with suggestions here, linking to particular songs where relevant.

ART



🎵 SONG: Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring! / A Perfect Day In Spring / It's A Spring Thing! / Because It's Springtime!

David Hockney (b. 1937) made a series of works **responding to the changing colours** of woodland (Woldgate Woods, Yorkshire) throughout the four seasons. He created oil paintings, charcoal drawings and iPad drawings, and recorded films as part of this series of work. How could the children use the influence of Hockney's work to respond to the colours and changing nature of spring?

- Take photos of the school grounds (field/flower beds/nature area throughout the season) to see how things have grown and changed. (Record in a school/class calendar to carry on throughout the year.)
- Record films of the school grounds.
- Incorporate technology to embrace Hockney's style: use iPads or tablets to create spring drawings and play back the creation of these to watch how they form into the finished work.



🎵 SONG: The Tadpole Song

Monet (1840-1926) made a series of 250 paintings depicting the water lilies in his garden throughout the different seasons; in these **he responded to the changing colours**, textures and light in the garden.

Is there a school pond that the children could study? If so, get them to create drawings and paintings, responding to it on different days throughout the seasons. (Or use another area of the school such as a garden or perhaps a tree.) How does it look in spring – are there new colours and shapes? **Have an exhibition** to celebrate all the different ways they individually perceive and respond to this scene.



SONG: Songbird

Using folded and painted paper plates, **create some fabulous songbird hand puppets**. See our wonderful craft video to learn how! www.outoftheark.co.uk/sfe-spring-assembly



ENGLISH



🎵 SONG: Caterpillar Munch

Can the children **spot all the rhyming words** in this song? For example:

Munch, lunch Crawl, wall Feast, beast

How about the **alliteration**?

Cabbage, kale Creep, crawl

Chewing, chomping Lettuce leaves

Can they come up with ideas of their own? Perhaps **writing a poem** or some **expanded noun phrases** to describe another minibeast of their choice. These would look great on a classroom display alongside some minibeast artwork.

🎵 SONG: April Showers

Read some poems about rain and see if you can pick out the **imagery** or other literary devices that the poet has used to **create atmosphere**. Write a list of the most effective phrases and see if the children can incorporate them into a piece of **descriptive writing** about rain. Play a YouTube video of rain sounds and images to inspire them whilst they write!

- *Spring Storm*, William Carlos Williams
- *The Rain*, William Henry Davies
- *Rain*, Robert Louis Stevenson
- *Rainy Nights*, Irene Thompson

🎵 SONG: Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring! / A Perfect Day In Spring / It's A Spring Thing! / Because It's Springtime! / Full Of The Joys!

Compose an **Acrostic Spring Poem**. As a class, brainstorm and collect spring words for each of the letters of **SPRING**. Then, ask the children to write some SPRING poems developing their favourite ideas/words into a line for each letter.



P.S.H.E



🎵 SONG: Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!

Make a list of all the changes that occur in nature, throughout the seasons. In the springtime in particular, there are so many changes to be **thankful** for! Explain that all of these changes happen for a reason.

Now make a list of all the other changes that can happen in life e.g. moving house or school or having a new member of the family. As a class, discuss the fact that these can be both positive and negative experiences. Discuss ways in which we can **develop resilience** and 'see the bigger picture', just as we might be sad to see the trees lose their leaves in the autumn, but we know there will be new life in the spring.

🎵 SONG: Full Of The Joys! / Sing Yourself A Happy Song

Happiness is an emotion we all enjoy. There are lots of phrases in the song *Full Of The Joys!* to describe how happiness/joy feels ('over the moon', 'on top of the world' etc.). How would the children describe this feeling? Why do they think we might feel happiness in springtime?

Sunshine peeping through the grey,
Petals sprouting, on their way.
Rainbows arching overhead,
Insects waking from their beds,
New life blooming everywhere,
Growing wild, without a care!

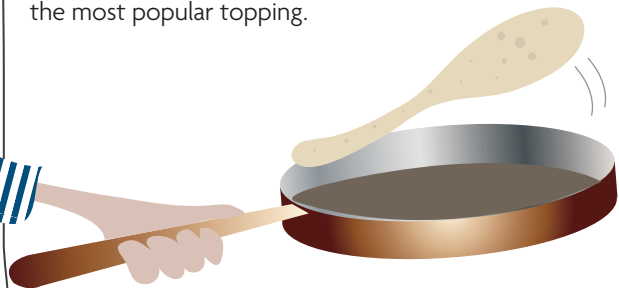


MATHS $M=a+3$

🎵 SONG: We're Making Pancakes

Can the children come up with some **maths word problems** to do with making pancakes? For example:

- If it takes me 3 minutes to cook 1 pancake, how long will it take to cook 4 pancakes?
- There are 3 people in my family. I have made 15 pancakes. How many will each person get?
- I like lemon and sugar on my pancake. My brother likes sugar and banana. My sister likes chocolate and banana. My mum likes strawberries and chocolate and my dad likes just chocolate. Make a tally chart to show the most popular topping.



P.E.



SONG: It's A Spring Thing! / April Showers / Full Of The Joys!

Use the famous **Singin' In the Rain** dance by Gene Kelly (1952) as inspiration to **choreograph your own dance**, to accompany either of these songs. There's surely potential for some **umbrella action** here!

SONG: Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!

Rainbow Dance, Len Lye (1936)
vimeo.com/154697834

This dance is a combination of experimental film, jazz and dance and is an inspiring watch! After watching the film, encourage the children to think about the movement that spring brings: plants **growing**; rain drops **falling**; children **running**, **jumping** and **skipping** in the playground. Then, think about the colours of spring. Create a contemporary dance piece that expresses this collision of movement and colours to showcase in one of your spring assemblies.

GEOGRAPHY



The arrival of spring is an important time of year, with celebrations taking place to mark the occasion all around the world. What **spring traditions and celebrations** do the children already know about? Find out about how Easter is celebrated in different countries. Other spring festivals include the Songkran Water Festival in Thailand, the Hanami cherry blossom festival in Japan, and the colourful Holi festival in India. Locate these places on a globe or atlas and ask groups to research a particular celebration and present their findings to the class.

SCIENCE



🎵 SONG: Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring! / A Perfect Day In Spring / It's A Spring Thing! / Because It's Springtime!

Organize a planting project: ask the children to bring a small plant from their garden or a seed or bulb from home. Find an area in the school garden, or use a collection of indoor plant pots for the classroom. Plant the bulbs and seeds and study their growth throughout the season, including measuring them with a ruler at regular intervals and charting the results alongside drawings of the seedlings as they develop. What conditions are required for healthy growth? At the end of the project, you might like to play a time-lapse video of a plant growing, such as www.youtube.com/watch?v=UvTRLyXr5xQ



🎵 SONG: The Tadpole Song / Caterpillar Munch

These two songs provide great opportunities to **investigate the life cycles** of frogs and butterflies. Can the children do their own research into one of these creatures, using books and/or computers? Discuss various ways they might like to present their results such as using PowerPoint, as a presentation to the class or in poster format.

R.E.



🎵 SONG: As The Sun Rises / Ring Out The Bells! / He Is Risen

[Vimeo.com/10185543](https://vimeo.com/10185543) by Alvin Ailey is a useful and informative dance to watch around **Easter time**. Ailey created this three-part dance about African-American history, which depicts the struggle from slavery to freedom. Its story can be interpreted to be more generally about struggle and conflict within oneself, but how **holding on to faith** can pull you through. The *Take Me To The Water* baptism scene is a good reference when thinking about Easter – the dancers perform as if they are being 'reborn', fitting the story of the resurrection. The final section is performed as the dancers rejoice in church. Here's an interview with the dancers talking about the dance itself: vimeo.com/159863911

MUSIC



Make it a routine to **play some classical music** at the beginning of the day – perhaps when the children are taking off their coats, settling in the classroom or entering an assembly. Here are some seasonally inspired suggestions:

- *Ballet Of The Unhatched Chicks*, Mussorgsky
- *On Hearing The First Cuckoo In Spring*, Delius
- *Frühlingslied (Spring Song)*, Mendelssohn
- *Spring from The Four Seasons*, Vivaldi
- *Rondes de Printemps*, Debussy
- *The Seasons*, Haydn
- *Spring, Op. 34*, Glazunov

SONG: April Showers

Play the children the backing track to *April Showers* and then this video of 'Little April Shower' from Disney's *Bambi*: www.youtube.com/watch?v=S-FUcrQhTBY. In both cases, ask the children to **listen very carefully to how rain is depicted in the music**. In the video, talk about how the rain starts slowly with the clarinet's single notes, then how the tempo increases when the triangle and voices come in. Listen out for the descriptive storm section in the middle in the minor key with cymbal crashes for the lightning, and then the return to the happy major song at the end (giving it an ABA structure). Use both tracks as inspiration for your own **class April-shower composition**.

